Zucchini Turkey Meatballs with Pesto Pasta

food processor recommended

Prep Time:

35-45 min

Cook Within:

5 days

Difficulty:

Expert

Spice Level:

Not Spicy

Nutrition (per serving)

Calories: 830

Carbs: 65g

Fat: 44g

Protein: 45g

Sodium: 1560mg

Contains: tree nuts (almonds), milk, wheat

Ingredients (Serves 2)

- 10 oz. Ground Turkey
- 1 Zucchini
- 5 oz. Rigatoni Pasta
- 1 Lemon
- 2 oz. Basil Pesto
- 1 oz. Grated Parmesan Cheese
- 1 oz. Creme Fraiche
- 1/2 oz. Roasted Sliced Almonds
- 1/2 oz. Baby Spinach
- 2 Tbsp. Italian Panko Blend
- 1/2 tsp. Lemon N Herb Seasoning
- 1/2 tsp. Garlic Salt

You'll Need

- 1 Box Grater
- 1 Baking Sheet
- 1 Medium Pot
- 2 Mixing Bowls
- 1 Food Processor
- 1 Zester
- 1 Colander/Strainer

Before You Cook

- Wash hands thoroughly with soap and warm water before cooking and after handling raw meat or seafood
- Remove all produce from any packaging or constraints, then thoroughly rinse and pat dry
- Turn oven on to 425 degrees. Let preheat, at least 10 minutes
- Bring 6 cups water and 1 tsp. salt to a boil in a medium pot
- Prepare a baking sheet with foil and cooking spray
- Ingredient(s) used more than once: cheese, zucchini, spinach, lemon

Instructions

1. Cook Pasta and Prepare Ingredients



Once water is boiling, add pasta and cook until al dente, 11-13 minutes.

Remove from burner. Transfer pasta to a mixing bowl with a slotted spoon, reserving pasta water in pot over low heat. Cover pasta to keep warm.

While pasta cooks, trim ends off zucchini and grate.

Thinly slice two spinach leaves for garnish (reserve remaining whole for homemade pesto). Keep sliced spinach and spinach leaves separate.

Zest and halve lemon. Cut one half into wedges and juice the other half.

2. Roast the Meatballs



Combine 1/2 cup zucchini (reserve remaining for homemade pesto), panko, half the cheese (reserve remaining for homemade pesto), lemon n herb seasoning, 1/4 tsp. salt, a pinch of pepper, and ground turkey in another mixing bowl. Form mixture into 8 evenly-sized meatballs.

Place meatballs on prepared baking sheet and top with 1 Tbsp. olive oil and a pinch of salt and pepper.

Roast in hot oven until meatballs reach a minimum internal temperature of 165 degrees, 15-20 minutes.

While meatballs roast, continue recipe.

3. Start the Homemade Pesto

Add whole spinach and remaining zucchini to hot reserved pasta water. Stir until just wilted, 45-60 seconds.

Drain spinach and zucchini in a colander/ strainer, shaking out any excess water. Set aside.



4. Finish the Homemade Pesto

Transfer spinach-zucchini mixture to a food processor.

Add basil pesto, remaining cheese, garlic salt, 2 tsp. lemon juice, creme fraiche, and 2 tsp. olive oil. Pulse until mixture is combined and smooth.

Alternatively, finely chop spinach and zucchini and combine with remaining ingredients.



5. Coat Pasta and Finish Dish

Transfer homemade pesto to bowl with pasta and stir until coated.

Plate dish as pictured on front of card, topping pasta with meatballs and garnishing with lemon zest (to taste), almonds, and sliced spinach. Squeeze lemon wedges over dish to taste. Bon appétit!

